

Friday, 7 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

24° 17°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

23° 13°

MANCHESTER

Light drizzle

20° 14°

GLASGOW

Light drizzle

18° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **There are calls for an inquiry into the Army Foundation College after multiple reports of rape and abuse from former students.**

Four women have told the BBC they were sexually assaulted and harassed while attending the college in Harrogate, North Yorkshire. This has led to serious concerns about the safety and welfare of young people at the institution.

CRIME · UK

2 **Shocking new figures reveal that every single river and lake in England is now polluted with chemicals.**

This comprehensive assessment is the first in six years, and unfortunately, it shows very little improvement in the health of our waterways. Environmental officials are now facing immense pressure to tackle this widespread issue.

ENVIRONMENT · UK

3 **A Cambridge professor at the centre of a plagiarism row has resigned from his position.**

Professor Jason Arday stated that stepping away was the only way to bring this difficult chapter to a close. The controversy had cast a shadow over his academic career and the university.

EDUCATION · UK

4 **Greater Manchester Mayor Andy Burnham has ordered a review into the early release of grooming gang offenders.**

This announcement follows concerns raised by the Tory leader that child sex offenders could be leaving jail prematurely. The review aims to ensure public safety and justice for victims.

POLITICS · UK

5 **All schools across England are set to receive pupil attendance targets, according to a new government plan.**

While schools won't be penalised for missing these targets, they will be closely monitored. The initiative aims to improve attendance rates and ensure children are in the classroom learning.

EDUCATION · UK

What's coming up

1

Great news for Rihanna fans – her partner A\$AP Rocky says the superstar is back in the studio and 'cooking' up new music!

It's been a long wait for a new album, with her last full release back in 2016. Fans have been eagerly anticipating her return to music, and it sounds like it might finally be happening.

ON AIR – What's your all-time favourite Rihanna track? And what kind of sound are you hoping for from her new material?

MUSIC · COMING SOON

2

Emmerdale actor Lawrence Robb, who plays Mackenzie 'Mack' Boyd, is the latest star to join the Strictly Come Dancing line-up!

Lawrence is a familiar face on ITV's popular soap and has also appeared in 'I Hate Suzie'. He'll be swapping the Dales for the dancefloor, hoping to impress the judges and viewers.

ON AIR – Who would you love to see join the Strictly line-up next? And do you think Lawrence has what it takes to lift the Glitterball trophy?

TV · THIS YEAR

3

Exciting news for music fans as the promoter behind Oasis's iconic Knebworth concerts has been granted a new events licence for the venue.

This isn't the first time rumours of a return to Knebworth Park have circulated, sparking speculation about potential major concerts. Could we see another legendary gig there soon?

ON AIR – If a huge band was playing Knebworth, who would you want it to be? And what's the best live concert you've ever been to?

MUSIC · COMING SOON

4

A major exhibition celebrating the life and career of Sir Billy Connolly is coming to Glasgow in 2027!

Titled 'Billy Connolly's Big Wee Exhibition', it will be held at the city's Kelvingrove Art Gallery from next June. It's a chance for fans to delve into the world of the beloved comedian.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Billy Connolly joke or routine? And what makes him such a national treasure?

ARTS · 2027

5

Secret Cinema is planning to build its first-ever long-term venue, after planning permission was granted for a 1,500-seat space.

The immersive cinema experience, known for its elaborate themed events, will create a permanent home in Greenwich Peninsula. This means more opportunities for fans to step into their favourite films.

ON AIR – If you could step into any film world with Secret Cinema, which one would it be? And what's the most immersive experience you've ever had?

FILM · COMING SOON

On the schedule

1 **Manchester City midfielder Rodri faces a huge decision this summer, with reports linking him to Barcelona or Real Madrid.**

Should he decide to leave the Premier League champions, two of Europe's biggest clubs are reportedly vying for his signature. It would be a massive move for the Spanish international.

ON AIR – If you were Rodri, would you stay with Man City or make the jump to La Liga? And which team would be a better fit for him?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Winter Olympic gold medallist Eve Muirhead has sensationally come out of retirement, four years after stepping away from curling.**

Muirhead, who was Team GB's chef de mission at this year's Games, says the experience inspired her to return to the sport. It's an exciting comeback for one of Britain's most decorated curlers.

ON AIR – What's the most inspiring comeback you've ever seen in sport? And do you think Eve can add more medals to her collection?

CURLING · UK

3 **Ollie Pope and Dan Lawrence have been recalled to the England squad for the first two Tests against Pakistan.**

The Surrey duo will be looking to make an impact as England prepare for an important series. However, Bethell misses out on a spot in the team.

ON AIR – Do you think these are the right choices for the England squad? And what do you predict for the upcoming Test series against Pakistan?

CRICKET · UK

4 **Trent Rockets continued their excellent form in The Hundred men's competition with a comfortable win against Birmingham Phoenix.**

They beat the Phoenix by seven wickets, moving four points clear at the top of the table with two matches left in the league phase. The Rockets are looking strong contenders for the title.

ON AIR – Are the Trent Rockets the team to beat in The Hundred this year? And who are you backing to win the men's competition?

CRICKET · UK

5 **Jos Buttler has made history, becoming the all-time leading run-scorer in T20 cricket!**

He achieved this incredible feat with an explosive 51 off just 20 balls, leading Manchester Super Giants to a nine-wicket win over Welsh Fire. His performance also moved his team up to third in The Hundred table.

ON AIR – What a milestone for Jos Buttler! Where does he rank among the greatest T20 players of all time? And what was your favourite moment from his record-breaking innings?

CRICKET · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Pubs report a Tuesday boom — the new 'mid-week meet' is the fastest-growing dining occasion.**
Operators say WFH-ers like getting out the house mid-week without the weekend crowds. Tuesday wine sales are up almost 30%.
- 2 Almost 70% of UK households now have a smart speaker — but the most common use is still 'asking what time it is'.**
Researchers say we under-use the devices we own. Setting timers, playing music and weather queries make up two thirds of all commands.
- 3 The 'silver gamer' is the fastest-growing demographic in UK gaming — over-65s spent £180 million on games last year.**
Cosy life-sim titles like Stardew Valley and Animal Crossing dominate. Console makers are reportedly designing larger UI for the market.
- 4 More of us are taking up 'fake commutes' — a short walk before and after working from home.**
Psychologists say the made-up journey helps separate work from home life. Some people even pop to a shop and back to 'arrive'.
- 5 Britain's appetite for 'cosy' nights in is reshaping Friday nights.**
Takeaway and streaming bookings now peak earlier in the evening, as more of us swap the big night out for a big night in.
- 6 Local 'repair cafés', where volunteers fix broken items for free, are spreading across the UK.**
Toasters, lamps and zips are the most common patients. Organisers say the biggest barrier is convincing people their old kettle is worth saving.
- 7 Charity shops are reporting a surge in both donations and shoppers as 'pre-loved' goes mainstream.**
Younger shoppers in particular are hunting for one-off finds. Volunteers say the most donated item by a mile is the unworn 'someday' outfit.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 69% of Brits do THIS as soon as they get in from work. What?
ANSWER: TAKE THEIR TROUSERS OFF AND PUT PYJAMA BOTTOMS ON.

Q 39% of us have done THIS in a supermarket trolley aisle. What?
ANSWER: HAD A FULL DOMESTIC ARGUMENT.

TALK TOPIC

- **Researchers say the average commute is the time we do our best thinking.**
What have you decided, planned or solved on the way to work?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **UK News.** A council in the North-West has agreed to fix a much-complained-about pothole only after a resident planted a small tree in it and the photo went viral. The pothole had been reported 17 times in a year before the tree solved it overnight.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A Devon village has voted unanimously to ban Vinted couriers from parking on its narrow high street, after a single delivery driver knocked over the same pub's hanging basket three weeks in a row.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£8.3 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£8.3 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Sharks existed before trees. Sharks have been around for 400 million years; trees only 350 million.
- Bubble wrap was originally invented as wallpaper. It flopped, so they pivoted to packaging.
- There are more stars in the universe than grains of sand on every beach on Earth.
- A group of flamingos is called a flamboyance.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar in 1896 — it lasted 38 minutes.
- Your stomach gets a new lining every three to four days. Otherwise it would digest itself.
- The first message ever sent on the internet was 'LO' — they were trying to type 'LOGIN' but the system crashed.
- An ostrich's eye is bigger than its brain.

On this day

Day 219 of the year, 146 days left in 2026. Today Assyrian Martyrs Day (Assyrian community); Battle of Boyacá Day (Colombia); Christian feast day: Afra; Christian feast day: Albert of Trapani. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1975 — Charlize Theron, South African actress
- 1944 — John Glover, American actor
- 1937 — Don Wilson, English cricketer and coach (died 2012)
- 1961 — Brian Conley, English actor and singer
- 1969 — Paul Lambert, Scottish footballer and manager
- 1983 — Mark Pettini, English cricketer and journalist
- 1965 — Raul Malo, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1974 — Chico Benymon, American actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1947 — Thor Heyerdahl's balsa wood raft, the Kon-Tiki, smashes into the reef at Raroia in the Tuamotu Islands after a 101-day, 7,000 kilometres (4,300 mi) journey across the Pacific Ocean in an attempt to prove that pre-historic peoples could have traveled from South America.
- 2008 — The start of the Russo-Georgian War over the territory of South Ossetia.
- 1969 — Richard Nixon appoints Luis R. Bruce, a Mohawk-Oglala Sioux and co-founder of the National Congress of American Indians, as the new commissioner of the Bureau of Indian Affairs.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1998 — Bombings at United States embassies in Dar es Salaam, Tanzania and Nairobi, Kenya kill approximately 212 people.
- 1993 — Ada Deer, a Menominee activist, is sworn in as the head of the Bureau of Indian Affairs.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1990 — First American soldiers arrive in Saudi Arabia as part of the Gulf War.
- 1985 — Takao Doi, Mamoru Mohri and Chiaki Mukai are chosen to be Japan's first astronauts.

- 1974 — Philippe Petit performs a high wire act between the Twin Towers of the World Trade Center 1,368 feet (417 m) in the air.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 220 of the year, 145 days left in 2026. Today Ceasefire Day (end of Iran–Iraq War) (Iraqi Kurdistan); Christian Feast Day: Altmann of Passau; Christian Feast Day: Bonifacia Rodríguez y Castro; Christian Feast Day: Cyriacus and companions. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1984 — Kirk Broadfoot, Scottish footballer
- 1976 — JC Chasez, American singer and dancer
- 1938 — Connie Stevens, American actress and businesswoman
- 1963 — Jon Turteltaub, American director and producer
- 1961 — The Edge, British-Irish musician, singer and songwriter
- 1974 — Brian Harvey, English singer-songwriter
- 1964 — Paul Taylor, English cricketer
- 1962 — Kool Moe Dee, American musician, singer and actor

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1991 — The Warsaw radio mast, then the tallest construction ever built, collapses.
- 2007 — An EF2 tornado touches down in Kings County and Richmond County, New York, the most powerful tornado in New York to date and the first in Brooklyn since 1889.
- 2009 — A Eurocopter AS350 Écureuil and Piper PA-32R collide over the Hudson River, killing nine people.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2004 — A tour bus belonging to the Dave Matthews Band dumps approximately 800 pounds of human waste onto a boat full of passengers.
- 2019 — An explosion at the State Central Navy Testing Range in Nyonoksa, Russia, kills five people.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)